Dr Ramesh Kancharla

Revolutionizing Pediatric Care for a Healthier Future

The future of any nation depends on the health and well-being of its children. Indian doctors are being respected worldwide for their ability, expertise and commitment. Despite the significant medical expertise, there are major hurdles in providing quality healthcare to all, for a populous and developing nation like ours. The troubles stand aggravated in case of childbirth and pediatric care, especially in the rural areas where children need to be taken miles away to receive immediate clinical intervention. Logistical / financial reasons and delays caused due to the unavailability of specialized services have been hindering the healthcare for newborns, children and mothers..

Hailing from a middle-class agricultural family of Nellore District, erstwhile Andhra Pradesh, Dr. Ramesh Kancharla, a pioneering doctor and healthcare entrepreneur felt compelled to act and turn this challenge into an opportunity. Having pursued his Doctor in Medicine (MD), Pediatrics, Dr. Ramesh trained as a specialist in pediatric gastroenterology, hepatology and nutrition, worked at prestigious medical centres in the United Kingdom like King's College Hospital, London and Great Ormond Street Children's Hospital, London. The learning and experiences acquired during his practice deepened his insights, and a glaring necessity of a dedicated multi-specialty children's hospital led him to start a similar children's hospital.

Thus, began the journey of the premier children's hospital in India with the name Rainbow Children's Hospital. The 50-bed children's hospital was set up in Hyderabad. Over the last two decades, despite initial hiccups where many opined that the need for an exclusive children's hospital was questionable, Dr. Ramesh Kancharla's commitment and conviction have ensured that they now operate 16 multi-specialty children's hospitals and three clinics with integrated perinatal care services under BirthRight by Rainbow Hospitals across the country in six cities namely Hyderabad, Vijayawada, Bengaluru, Delhi, Chennai, and Visakhapatnam.



They currently offer a variety of services like the newborn and pediatric intensive care, pediatric multi-specialty services, and pediatric quaternary care (including organ transplantation). BirthRight offers normal and complex obstetric care, fetal medicine and perinatal genetics, gynecology and fertility services.

Rainbow group believes in evidence-based quality treatment for the little ones and understands that "it takes a lot to treat the little." Their problem-solving approach has made them pioneers in the field as they take a multi-disciplinary approach with a strong team work. The perinatal services have been integrated for seamless care right from first heartbeat till the delivery and get continued care till they become adults.

World-wide, children's hospitals work on very similar fundamentals of a multi-disciplinary and child centric approach and full-time doctor engagement model. Along with Dr Ramesh, many of his senior colleagues were trained in developed countries like UK, Canada, Australia and the United States. "We understand that children's hospitals work 24/7 basis, with majority of admissions coming through emergencies during the nights. Consultant led services are absolutely essential to attend emergencies as well as to run 24/7 intensive care services.", explains Dr Ramesh. It is notable that the USA has 250 children's hospitals and almost 97% of the medical care for children is delivered by children's hospitals including complex surgeries like organ transplantation.

The unique needs and intricacies of children cannot be fully addressed within the environment of an adult hospital. Despite the growth of adult hospitals, the concept of dedicated children's hospitals is nascent in India. Treating children as miniature adults is inadequate, as the first three years of their development shape their adult lives in terms of physical, physiological, mental, and emotional aspects. Any aberrations or infections during this crucial phase can significantly hamper their growth and health. The focus of Rainbow Group